

MistGuard — Touchless Sunscreen Booths

Ten seconds, full coverage, no sticky hands.

What It Is

A self-service, touchless sunscreen application booth placed at beaches, pools, resorts, and water parks. Customers step inside, select their height and SPF, and a fine mist coats their whole body evenly in about ten seconds. It solves real pain — sticky hands, missed spots, sunburned backs — and runs largely unattended, earning revenue while you sleep.

How It Makes Money

Pay-per-spray. Customers tap a card or scan a QR to pay \$5-\$8 per application. Buyers are sun-exposed crowds who forgot or hate applying lotion: beachgoers, hotel guests, families with kids, festival attendees. Add recurring B2B revenue by leasing booths to resorts/water parks on a revenue-share, plus branded sponsorship from sunscreen brands who pay to stock the machine.

Startup Costs

- Touchless sunscreen booth unit (Snappy Screen-style or generic spray-booth): **\$6,000-\$18,000** — Alibaba search "automatic spray tanning sunscreen booth machine"
- Bulk reef-safe sunscreen mist concentrate (first stock): **\$300-\$800**
- Payment terminal + QR/tap kiosk: **\$200-\$500**
- Branded wrap, signage, weatherproof canopy: **\$400-\$1,200**
- Location permit / vendor agreement / insurance: **\$500-\$2,000**
- Transport + install: **\$300-\$800**
- Per-unit import note: a single spray-booth from China lands around **\$6,000-\$12,000** including freight; cost drops sharply at 3+ units.
- **Total to launch one booth: ~\$8,000-\$22,000**

The Numbers

- Sunscreen + power + payment fee per spray: **~\$0.40-\$0.70**
- Sell each application at **\$5** → profit **~\$4.30-\$4.60 per spray**
- 100 sprays/day × \$4.40 = **~\$440/day per booth**
- Monthly (busy season, one booth): **~\$12,000-\$13,000 gross**, **~\$8,000-\$10,000 net** after location share and maintenance.
- Add 2-3 booths across a resort cluster and a single operator clears **\$25,000-\$30,000/month** in peak season.

How To Start

1. Source one booth unit and negotiate sample sunscreen concentrate compatible with the sprayer.
2. Sign a placement deal with a beach club, hotel pool, or water park — offer them 15-25% of revenue so they say yes.
3. Set up tap/QR payment and a simple usage dashboard.
4. Wrap the booth with bold, benefit-led branding ("Full coverage in 10 seconds").
5. Install, test SPF/height settings, and stock reef-safe mist.

6. Staff lightly (one attendant to refill and upsell) during peak hours; otherwise run unattended.
7. Reinvest the first booth's profit into booths 2 and 3 at adjacent high-traffic sites.

Where To Get Customers

- Placement is acquisition: put booths where sunburn happens — beaches, pools, resorts, water parks, outdoor festivals
- Hotel/resort partnerships and concierge referrals
- On-site signage and a staff demo during opening week
- Sunscreen-brand sponsorship deals (they fund product for logo placement)
- Reels of the misting moment to drive curiosity and walk-ups

Pro Tips

- Lead with location deals, not ownership. Revenue-share placement gets you into premium spots with zero rent and the venue does your marketing.
- Use reef-safe, fast-dry formula only — one bad sticky experience kills repeat use and reviews.
- Stack booths in clusters. Maintenance, restocking, and one attendant cover multiple machines, so margins climb fast after booth one.